

Kestrel Hartwell

Character Dossier

Cynical mentor who wants to be proven wrong tax collector of the Dust Road caravan routes

Overview

Kestrel Hartwell is a tax collector living in the Dust Road caravan routes. Kestrel is 19 years old, originally from the Mirefold, and is known around Wayrest Springs as cynical mentor who wants to be proven wrong. In conversation Kestrel swears by the weather instead of the gods.

Background

Kestrel arrived in the Dust Road caravan routes 13 years ago after leaving the Mirefold under circumstances Kestrel describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Caravaners' Compact; the second was the one that stuck. Today Kestrel works as a tax collector near the Salt Flats and is paid, when paid at all, in trade tokens.

Kestrel learned the trade from Rurik Kettleburn, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Kestrel's life is with Osric Ashgrove, over a matter neither will explain. The person Kestrel trusts most is Qadira Lindqvist.

Current goal: to reopen the shop their parents lost. Greatest fear: the bells at midnight.

Personality and speech

Temperament: cynical mentor who wants to be proven wrong.

Speech pattern: Kestrel swears by the weather instead of the gods.

Tells: when lying, Kestrel mentions Sorrow the hound for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

<i>Full name</i>	Kestrel Hartwell
<i>Role</i>	tax collector
<i>Home</i>	the Dust Road caravan routes
<i>Hometown</i>	the Mirefold
<i>Age</i>	19
<i>Favourite dish</i>	cold smoked pepper hummus
<i>Pet</i>	Sorrow, a hound
<i>Lucky number</i>	462

<i>Workshop password</i>	oak-quill
<i>Mentor</i>	Rurik Kettleburn
<i>Rival</i>	Osric Ashgrove
<i>Closest friend</i>	Qadira Lindqvist

Secret

Kestrel has a sibling nobody in the Dust Road caravan routes knows about, living quietly in the Mirefold.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Kestrel: I am the tax collector. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Kestrel: Cold smoked pepper hummus. Do not tell Osric I said so.

Visitor: Is Sorrow yours?

Kestrel: Sorrow belongs to nobody. Sorrow tolerates me. Lucky number is 462, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, winter of year 27

Ursula came by asking about the right way to mend a net. Kestrel said nothing useful and made tea instead. At Emberfall Pass, Kestrel taught Qadira how to tell a real coil of rope from a fake one by weight alone. A dispute over the old tunnels flared up between Kestrel and Osric outside Emberfall Pass; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A stranger asked Kestrel for the password to the workshop. Kestrel laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Rosalind came by asking about the harvest count. Kestrel said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 2, autumn of year 27

Kestrel was hired to carry a hand bell from Three Crows junction to Wayrest Springs without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Rumours about the price of lamp oil reached Three Crows junction. Kestrel pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Kestrel found a copper pipe half-buried near Three Crows junction and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Rurik visited unannounced. They argued about who really won the regatta for an hour and parted better friends than before. Kestrel was hired to carry a bundle of letters from Three Crows junction to Wayrest Springs without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 3, autumn of year 27

Kestrel found a wax seal half-buried near Three Crows junction and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Someone left a grain scale on the doorstep with no note. Kestrel suspects Qadira and is probably right. Kestrel repaired the coil of rope at Three Crows junction for Fenwick, who paid in 71 trade tokens and a long story about whether the bridge will hold. Kestrel was hired to carry a signal flag from Three Crows junction to the Salt Flats without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Someone left a sextant on the doorstep with no note. Kestrel suspects Qadira and is probably right.

Entry 4, summer of year 27

At Emberfall Pass, Kestrel taught Qadira how to tell a real pair of spectacles from a fake one by weight alone. the Caravaners' Compact sent a notice about the tariff on salt. Kestrel read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Rumours about the quarantine reached Emberfall Pass. Kestrel pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Kestrel closed early, walked to Three Crows junction, and watched the lights come on. Sorrow followed at a distance. A stranger asked Kestrel for the password to the workshop. Kestrel laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 5, winter of year 28

Kestrel closed early, walked to Emberfall Pass, and watched the lights come on. Sorrow followed at a distance. Olwen came by asking about the comet. Kestrel said nothing useful and made tea instead. Kestrel repaired the bolt of linen at Three Crows junction for Qadira, who paid in 57 trade tokens and a long story about the missing shipment. Rurik visited unannounced. They argued about who really won the regatta for an hour and parted better friends than before. Kestrel closed early, walked to Emberfall Pass, and watched the lights come on. Sorrow followed at a distance.

Entry 6, summer of year 28

Kestrel was hired to carry a cracked compass from Wayrest Springs to Emberfall Pass without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Rumours about the harvest count reached Wayrest Springs. Kestrel pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Kestrel found a copper pipe half-buried near Wayrest Springs and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. The weather turned. Kestrel moved the signal flag indoors, fed Sorrow, and wrote three lines to Rurik about the missing shipment. A dispute over the census flared up between Kestrel and Osric outside Wayrest Springs; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 7, spring of year 28

A dispute over who really won the regatta flared up between Kestrel and Osric outside Wayrest Springs; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A dispute over the census flared up between Kestrel and Osric outside Wayrest Springs; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. the Caravaners' Compact sent a notice about the price of lamp oil. Kestrel read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Rurik visited unannounced. They argued about the missing shipment for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 8, spring of year 28

Kestrel repaired the oilskin map at the Salt Flats for Kenji, who paid in 72 trade tokens and a long story about who really won the regatta. A dispute over the old tunnels flared up between Kestrel and Osric outside the Salt Flats; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. At the Salt Flats, Kestrel taught Qadira how to tell a real tin whistle from a fake one by weight alone. the Caravaners' Compact sent a notice about the harvest count. Kestrel read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Kestrel spent the day counting stock at the Salt Flats: 74 of everything, except the grain scale, which is always short.

Entry 9, autumn of year 28

A dispute over the price of lamp oil flared up between Kestrel and Osric outside the Cracked Cistern; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. At the Cracked Cistern, Kestrel taught Qadira how to tell a real signal flag from a fake one by weight alone. A dispute over the missing shipment flared up between Kestrel and Osric outside the Cracked Cistern; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. The weather turned. Kestrel moved the spool of wire indoors, fed Sorrow, and wrote three lines to Rurik about the new curfew.

Entry 10, winter of year 28

At the Cracked Cistern, Kestrel taught Qadira how to tell a real pair of spectacles from a fake one by weight alone. Kestrel repaired the grain scale at the Cracked Cistern for Zeph, who paid in 85 trade tokens and a long story about the harvest count. A stranger asked Kestrel for the password to the workshop. Kestrel laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 11, autumn of year 28

Rumours about the right way to mend a net reached the Salt Flats. Kestrel pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Kestrel repaired the tin whistle at the Salt Flats for Wilhelmina, who paid in 44 trade tokens and a long story about the new curfew. Kestrel was hired to carry a brass lantern

from the Salt Flats to Three Crows junction without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Kestrel spent the day counting stock at the Salt Flats: 38 of everything, except the cracked compass, which is always short.

Entry 12, summer of year 28

Jorah came by asking about whether the bridge will hold. Kestrel said nothing useful and made tea instead. A stranger asked Kestrel for the password to the workshop. Kestrel laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. The weather turned. Kestrel moved the spool of wire indoors, fed Sorrow, and wrote three lines to Rurik about the census.

Entry 13, summer of year 28

At the Cracked Cistern, Kestrel taught Qadira how to tell a real clockwork bird from a fake one by weight alone. Rurik visited unannounced. They argued about the quarantine for an hour and parted better friends than before. Kestrel closed early, walked to Three Crows junction, and watched the lights come on. Sorrow followed at a distance. Kestrel repaired the cracked compass at the Cracked Cistern for Baptiste, who paid in 30 trade tokens and a long story about the tax on doors.

Entry 14, spring of year 28

Kestrel was hired to carry a grain scale from Emberfall Pass to the Salt Flats without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Kestrel won 21 trade tokens from Osric on a bet about the new curfew and spent all of it on cold smoked pepper hummus. Rumours about the harvest count reached Emberfall Pass. Kestrel pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Rurik visited unannounced. They argued about the right way to mend a net for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 15, autumn of year 28

The weather turned. Kestrel moved the coil of rope indoors, fed Sorrow, and wrote three lines to Rurik about the harvest count. Kestrel closed early, walked to Emberfall Pass, and watched the lights come on. Sorrow followed at a distance. Rurik visited unannounced. They argued about the quarantine for an hour and parted better friends than before. Rurik visited unannounced. They argued about who really won the regatta for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 16, winter of year 28

Kestrel closed early, walked to Wayrest Springs, and watched the lights come on. Sorrow followed at a distance. the Caravaners' Compact sent a notice about who really won the regatta. Kestrel read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. The weather turned. Kestrel moved the pair of spectacles indoors, fed Sorrow, and wrote three lines to Rurik about the tax on doors.

Entry 17, spring of year 28

Kestrel closed early, walked to the Salt Flats, and watched the lights come on. Sorrow followed at a distance. Rurik visited unannounced. They argued about who really won the regatta for an hour and parted better friends than before. Rumours about the tariff on salt reached Wayrest Springs. Kestrel pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 18, summer of year 28

At Emberfall Pass, Kestrel taught Qadira how to tell a real brass lantern from a fake one by weight alone. Kestrel was hired to carry a brass lantern from Emberfall Pass to Wayrest Springs without opening it, and mostly succeeded. At Emberfall Pass, Kestrel taught Qadira how to tell a real sextant from a fake one by weight alone. Rumours about the census reached Emberfall Pass. Kestrel pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 19, spring of year 28

Kestrel closed early, walked to Three Crows junction, and watched the lights come on. Sorrow followed at a distance. Rumours about the new curfew reached the Salt Flats. Kestrel pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. At the Salt Flats, Kestrel taught Qadira how to tell a real ledger from a fake one by weight alone. Lucienne came by asking about the comet. Kestrel said nothing useful and made tea instead. Kestrel was hired to carry a grain scale from the Salt Flats to Three Crows junction without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 20, spring of year 28

The weather turned. Kestrel moved the signal flag indoors, fed Sorrow, and wrote three lines to Rurik about the harvest count. Someone left a spool of wire on the doorstep with no note. Kestrel suspects Qadira and is probably right. Rumours about whether the bridge will hold reached Wayrest Springs. Kestrel pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Kestrel won 73 trade tokens from Osric on a bet about the census and spent all of it on cold smoked pepper hummus.

Entry 21, summer of year 29

A dispute over the harvest count flared up between Kestrel and Osric outside Three Crows junction; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. the Caravaners' Compact sent a notice about who really won the regatta. Kestrel read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Kestrel closed early, walked to the Salt Flats, and watched the lights come on. Sorrow followed at a distance. Dashiell came by asking about the comet. Kestrel said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 22, winter of year 29

The weather turned. Kestrel moved the glass float indoors, fed Sorrow, and wrote three lines to Rurik about the new curfew. A dispute over the quarantine flared up between Kestrel and Osric outside Wayrest Springs; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Someone left a coil of rope on the doorstep with no note. Kestrel suspects Qadira and is probably right.

Entry 23, spring of year 29

A stranger asked Kestrel for the password to the workshop. Kestrel laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Someone left a pair of spectacles on the doorstep with no note. Kestrel suspects Qadira and is probably right. Kestrel spent the day counting stock at the Salt Flats: 65 of everything, except the bolt of linen, which is always short.

Entry 24, autumn of year 29

Rurik visited unannounced. They argued about the old tunnels for an hour and parted better friends than before. Kestrel found a ledger half-buried near Wayrest Springs and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A stranger asked Kestrel for the password to the workshop. Kestrel laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 25, autumn of year 30

Kestrel closed early, walked to Three Crows junction, and watched the lights come on. Sorrow followed at a distance. Rurik visited unannounced. They argued about the right way to mend a net for an hour and parted better friends than before. Phaedra came by asking about the tariff on salt. Kestrel said nothing useful and made tea instead. A stranger asked Kestrel for the password to the workshop. Kestrel laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 26, summer of year 30

Kestrel repaired the oilskin map at the Salt Flats for Quentin, who paid in 31 trade tokens and a long story about the tax on doors. A dispute over the census flared up between Kestrel and Osrice outside the Salt Flats; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Kestrel repaired the signal flag at the Salt Flats for Amadou, who paid in 59 trade tokens and a long story about the quarantine. Someone left a grain scale on the doorstep with no note. Kestrel suspects Qadira and is probably right. Kestrel repaired the sack of salt at the Salt Flats for Matthias, who paid in 28 trade tokens and a long story about the rumour of a second well.

Entry 27, winter of year 30

The weather turned. Kestrel moved the signal flag indoors, fed Sorrow, and wrote three lines to Rurik about the singing at the docks. Kestrel won 85 trade tokens from Osrice on a bet about the tax on doors and spent all of it on cold smoked pepper hummus. A stranger asked Kestrel for the password to the workshop. Kestrel laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Kestrel spent the day counting stock at the Cracked Cistern: 40 of everything, except the bundle of letters, which is always short.

Entry 28, summer of year 30

A dispute over the rumour of a second well flared up between Kestrel and Osrice outside Wayrest Springs; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. At Wayrest Springs, Kestrel taught Qadira how to tell a real oilskin map from a fake one by weight alone. Someone left a iron kettle on the doorstep with no note. Kestrel suspects Qadira and is probably right.